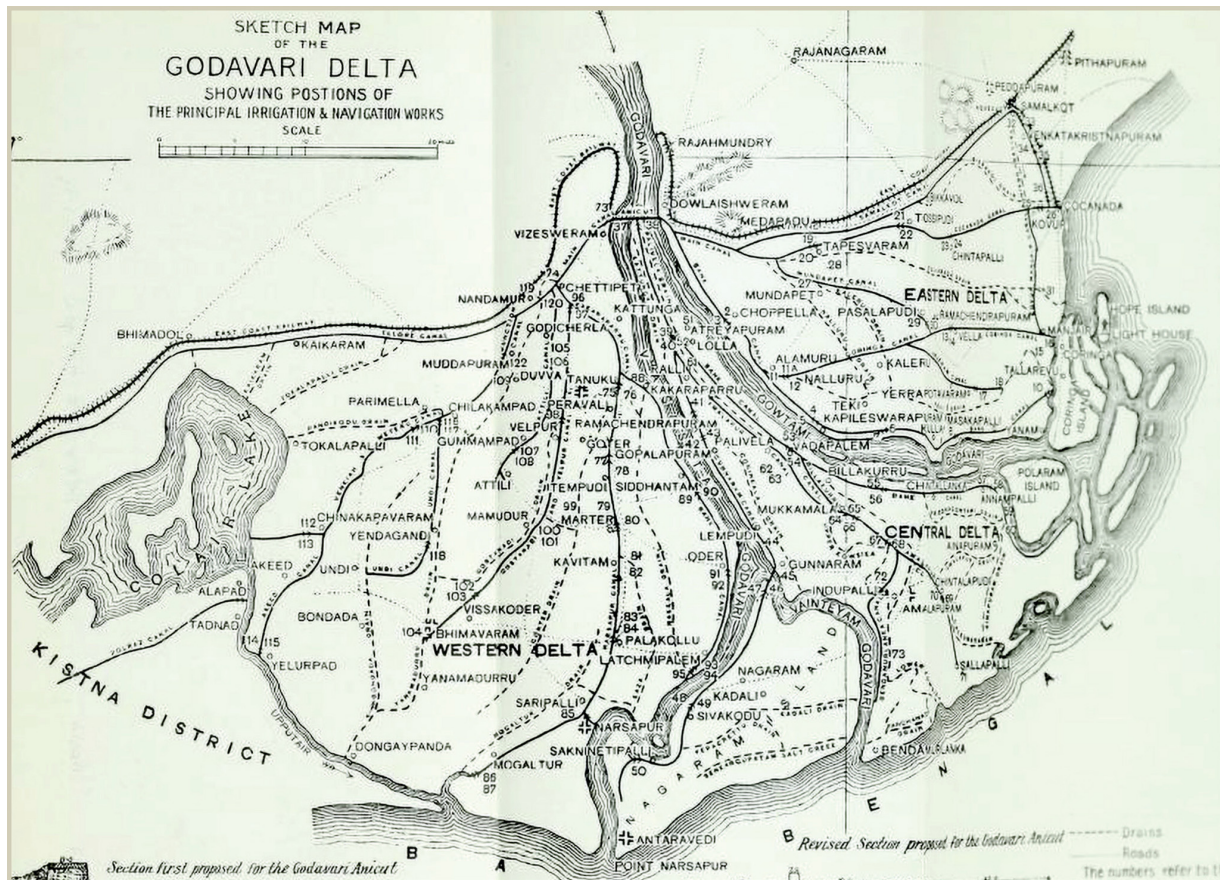


cut stone as well as teak tree battens fixed with iron bars. Wagons, pulled by ponies and men, rolled on these tracks, except on the slope at the end where they could roll down by themselves. With the opening of this line, stone could be easily transported to the river bank from where it was taken on boats. Even though the line was supposed to be permanent, it ceased to exist post the completion of the dam project in 1852.



▲ The fertile Godavari delta had many irrigation and navigation works. The first railway lines came up to support the construction of dams near it.

## The first locomotive

In 1845, work began on an irrigation project on the Ganges Canal. It included the construction of an aqueduct to flow the canal across the Solani River in Roorkee (in modern-day Uttarakhand). Ballast trucks and wagons, hauled by humans and animals, rolled across the extent of this railway. It is also, perhaps, the first instance of the use of a steam locomotive, named *Thomason*, which was a 4 ft 8.5 in gauge tank